

and developers was also predominantly made up of MySQL (and now Oracle) employees. PostgreSQL on the other hand consists of thousands of independent contributors and companies. We follow something like the Red Hat model in how we work with the PostgreSQL community, in that we support the development of many community features and employ a number of community leaders and contributors. The main advantage I think is it should provide to all users of PostgreSQL a sense of comfort that it is an open source project, which is independent.

Q Can you please elaborate on EnterpriseDB's Postgres Plus product family?

EnterpriseDB originally started with a vision of providing database users a lower cost alternative to Oracle and other proprietary databases. Postgres Plus Advanced Server is EnterpriseDB's flagship product and allows relatively easy migration off Oracle by allowing applications running on Oracle databases to run on Postgres Plus Advanced Server with minimal effort. Postgres Plus Advanced Server always remains in synch with the community project and incorporates additional features required by our enterprise customers. It is also fast becoming the database of choice for new application developments.

In addition, the company also has a very strong presence in the support of PostgreSQL itself. We offer support subscriptions and services to companies that want to use open source and open source products around PostgreSQL. We have a lot of tools, including Postgres Enterprise manager and Postgres Plus Cloud Database, all of which have been developed around PostgreSQL to enhance the usage, depending upon what your needs are. What EnterpriseDB does is that it allows companies to enjoy much lower costs afforded by open source based products while retaining the security of Enterprise class support. We are taking a community project to the companies looking to adopt solutions that they can have a control over, in a cost-friendly way.

Q To what extent can a company get involved in an open source project, before which the independence of the community gets compromised?

We, as a company, make sure that we support and contribute to the independence of the community because we are very cognizant of the fact that EnterpriseDB without the community, its contribution and its creations, would not provide the same value to our customers. The community is an important part of who we are. The way that the company provides support to the community is by employing some of its key members. There are many companies which do that. We are one of them. We also enable our

"Since PostgreSQL is an independent community, it makes for a compelling story. It has grown with no company ownership and is not privately held. It creates a stronger story for the use of open source."

employees to give some of their time to developing community projects, which are open source and available to all. In that process, we also see how enterprise needs are met. The enterprise need is often driven by specific requirements related to the nature of the project. We discuss our insights into these issues with the community members.

If a customer needs features or technologies that are not on the community roadmap then we often develop the changes and offer them to customers. EnterpriseDB has a lot of database expertise within the company itself. Working closely with the community is very important for us. I compliment the community for the way it thinks and works, because its members do not get influenced by any one company at the end of the day. Any company being able to take over the community or impose its will on a community, rather than working in a collaborative manner, is actually detrimental to the community. We are proud of our approach to working with the community.

Q Can you elaborate on some of your initiatives to involve developers in the community so that the product evolves well?

We do a lot of evangelising. As you are aware, PostgreSQL has been able to establish itself well in the market, and anyone who wants to develop a project should be aware of the PostgreSQL database. We sponsor a lot of events around PostgreSQL to make sure that there is enough buzz about the project. We are launching training programmes across the globe, especially in India, which is a unique place where we have a lot of engineering talent that is always looking out for new technologies. We are getting into colleges and are offering training courses to help students understand PostgreSQL. Today, the college curriculum does not have PostgreSQL incorporated. We are also talking to government agencies, who prepare a lot of database curriculum for government organisations. We are having continuous conversations on introducing PostgreSQL into the curriculum, so that students coming out of colleges already know the technology. Given the fact that adoption of PostgreSQL is increasing, this will make the talent ready for the technology and also create employment opportunities. **END** 